hold because the Government of India have [sic] been uniformly in sympathy with their desires.'[148] Just as with the Gandhi issue, however, the Indian government came under criticism from the Home government for its reticence in being heavy-handed with the Caliphate movement. The Foreign Office believed the Indian government was simply looking on and watching the opposition grow,[149] while Curzon argued that the movement was being 'rendered formidable by [the] shocking weakness of the Gov. of India'.[150]

The first test for the Indian government's policy came on 15 May when the proposed Turkish peace treaty was made public. Among the terms was the removal of Smyrna and Thrace from Turkish authority to be placed in Greek hands.[151] This move was actually opposed by a number of figures in the British establishment, particularly among military members and the Indian government, who believed not only would it incite Muslim unrest but that Britain lacked the military capability to enforce it. However, as Wilson noted in his diary in June 1920, Lloyd George 'is as much convinced as ever that the Greeks are splendid soldiers and the Turks perfectly useless. It is a most dangerous obsession.'[152] Indeed, if Curzon was the champion of Britain's Persian policy in 1920, then the prime minister was the key orchestrator of the Turkish peace. It was due, in large measure, to the anti-Turkish-pro-Greek 'personal policy' of Lloyd George that the British Empire was to become even further estranged from the Muslim world in 1920.[153] As Admiral de Robeck warned, 'the proposal to dismember the Ottoman provinces of Turkey in the interests of Greece will drive the remaining Turks into the arms of the Bolsheviks, will set the Near East and Central Asia aflame, and will intensify the menace of Bolshevism to the British Moslem world'.[154]

In an effort to temper any potential trouble, Chelmsford published a message to all Indian Muslims acknowledging that the proposed treaty terms must be painful to them and asking them to accept the agreement 'with resignation, courage and fortitude and to keep your loyalty towards the Crown bright and untarnished...'[155] Despite such worries, however, the immediate reaction to news of the proposed treaty was actually relatively muted. The disturbances which the Indian government had been bracing themselves for did not materialise.[156] Instead, it seemed that the extremists of the Caliphate movement had succeeded through their violent speeches in